SPRINT 2: Research & Strategy Document

Customer Personas

Primary Persona 1: Thabo Mokoena
Demographics: 32 years old, Male, Johannesburg, South Africa, Full-time sales executive, middle income.
Psychographics: Values convenience, status, and reliability; interested in modern tech and luxury brands.
Behaviors: Spends time browsing car marketplaces online, prefers direct communication via messaging apps.
Needs: Easy access to verified vehicle listings, transparent pricing, quick financing options.
Pain Points: Time wasted on unreliable sellers, unclear pricing.
Motivations: Impress clients, maintain a stylish lifestyle.
Bio: Thabo is a driven sales executive looking for a stylish car that boosts his image while remaining reliable for daily commutes.
Goal: Buy a luxury sedan with minimal hassle.
Frustration: Inconsistent information and unresponsive sellers.

Primary Persona 2: Lerato Ndlovu
Demographics: 28 years old, Female, Cape Town, South Africa, Event planner, upper-middle income.
Psychographics: Values style, punctuality, and flexibility; eco-conscious.
Behaviors: Rents cars frequently for events, compares prices online.
Needs: Access to various car types for short-term rental, reliable pick-up and drop-off services.
Pain Points: Hidden fees, limited vehicle availability during peak seasons.
Motivations: Provide exceptional client experiences with premium transportation.
Bio: Lerato organizes high-end events and often needs luxury SUVs or sports cars for client transport.
Goal: Secure stylish rental cars for events quickly.
Frustration: Delayed bookings and last-minute cancellations.

Secondary Persona 1: Sipho Dlamini
Demographics: 24 years old, Male, Durban, South Africa, University student, low to middle income.
Psychographics: Budget-conscious, tech-savvy, values cost over brand.
Behaviors: Looks for affordable rentals for weekend trips.
Needs: Cheap daily rental options.
Pain Points: Poorly maintained budget cars.
Motivations: Affordable transport for short trips.
Bio: Sipho studies IT and enjoys weekend adventures with friends.
Goal: Rent a car for trips without overspending.
Frustration: Paying too much for low-quality cars.

Secondary Persona 2: Amanda Jacobs
Demographics: 45 years old, Female, Pretoria, South Africa, Small business owner, middle to high income.
Psychographics: Values efficiency, professionalism, and service reliability.
Behaviors: Buys vehicles for business purposes.
Needs: Fleet purchase options, after-sales support.
Pain Points: Poor customer service, lack of business packages.

Motivations: Reliable business transport.
Bio: Amanda runs a catering business and needs vans for deliveries.
Goal: Buy multiple vehicles at a competitive price.
Frustration: No tailored business offers.

Discovery Notes
Market research shows high demand for verified online car sales and rentals, especially in urban areas. Users value transparency, a wide selection, and a seamless online-to-offline experience. Trust is a major factor in purchasing and renting decisions.

Competitor Analysis Summary
Direct Competitors: Autotrader, Cars.co.za – Large car sales platforms with extensive listings, focus on buying/selling, limited rental options.
Indirect Competitors: Avis, Europcar – Established rental services with high pricing, limited flexibility.
Opportunities: Combine sales and rentals in one platform, offer transparent pricing, target both individual and business clients, integrate reviews and ratings for trust.

Initial Brand Positioning
AutoCrib will position itself as the all-in-one platform for car sales and rentals in South Africa, combining verified listings, transparent pricing, and a user-friendly interface. The brand will emphasize trust, convenience, and premium service, targeting both everyday consumers and business clients.